

Brain-Based Mental Health Community

Collaborative and Proactive Solutions (CPS) Feedback

NAME

DATE

Review the live website before providing feedback:

<https://tcfasd.github.io/Brain-Based-Mental-Health-/handout-therapy-guide.html>

Also known as: Collaborative Problem Solving (former name); "The Explosive Child" approach (Ross Greene, PhD) All ages | Brain-Based

What It Asks the Brain to Do:

CPS is a non-punitive approach based on the premise that "kids do well if they can" — not "kids do well if they want to." Challenging behavior is understood as the result of lagging skills (flexibility, frustration tolerance, problem-solving) rather than lack of motivation. CPS does NOT try to motivate better behavior through rewards and consequences. Instead, it identifies the specific unsolved problems causing the behavior and teaches the child's brain to participate in solving those problems collaboratively with an adult. It uses "Plan B" conversations: an empathy step (understanding the child's concern), a define-the-adult-concern step, and an invitation to brainstorm solutions together.

Caregiver Involvement:

Very high. Caregivers are taught the CPS framework and implement it at home. The caregiver shifts from trying to impose solutions ("Plan A") or giving in ("Plan C") to collaborating with the child ("Plan B").

How to Know If It Might Be a Good Fit:

- Your child has meltdowns, explosions, or extreme rigidity
- Traditional reward and consequence approaches haven't worked — or have made things worse
- Your child seems to struggle with flexibility and frustration tolerance, not just "won't listen"
- You are ready to shift from a compliance-focused to a problem-solving-focused approach

Brain-Based Consideration

CPS's core assumption — that challenging behavior reflects lagging skills, not lack of motivation — aligns perfectly with a brain-based understanding. For children whose brains genuinely cannot produce the flexibility or problem-solving demanded of them, CPS meets them where they are. The emphasis on solving specific, concrete problems (rather than abstract behavior goals) is an excellent fit for brain-based differences.

1. Is what is written accurate?

Yes

No

Yes

2. Is there additional information that you think caregivers should know about Collaborative and Proactive Solutions (CPS)?

Thank you for your feedback!